

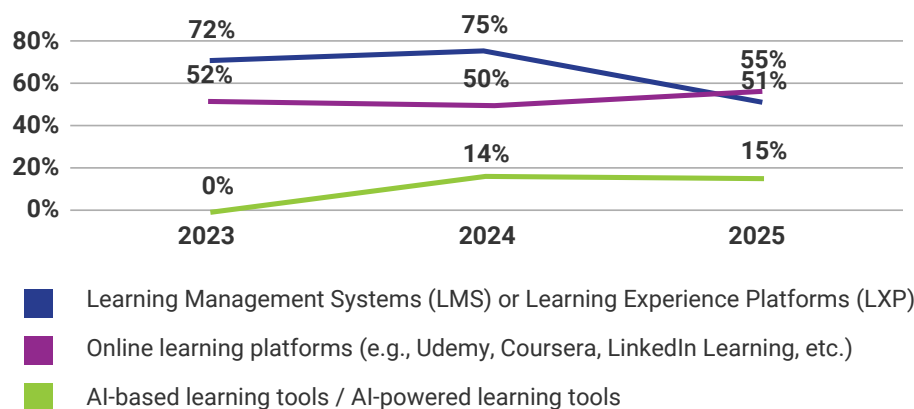
Software System Integration, Architecture Failures, and Performance Gaps



Finding: Over two-thirds of organizations use a Learning Management System (LMS) or Learning Experience Platform (LXP)

Traditional learning platforms continue to serve as the foundation of most learning technology ecosystems. Over two-thirds of organizations (67%) report using an LMS or LXP, making these platforms the most widely adopted learning technologies in the study. Although learning platforms remain dominant, longitudinal findings suggest that organizations are gradually expanding their technology portfolios beyond traditional systems. LMS adoption stood at 72% in 2023 and 75% in 2024 and dropped to 51% in 2025, indicating that growth has largely plateaued as organizations explore additional learning technologies.

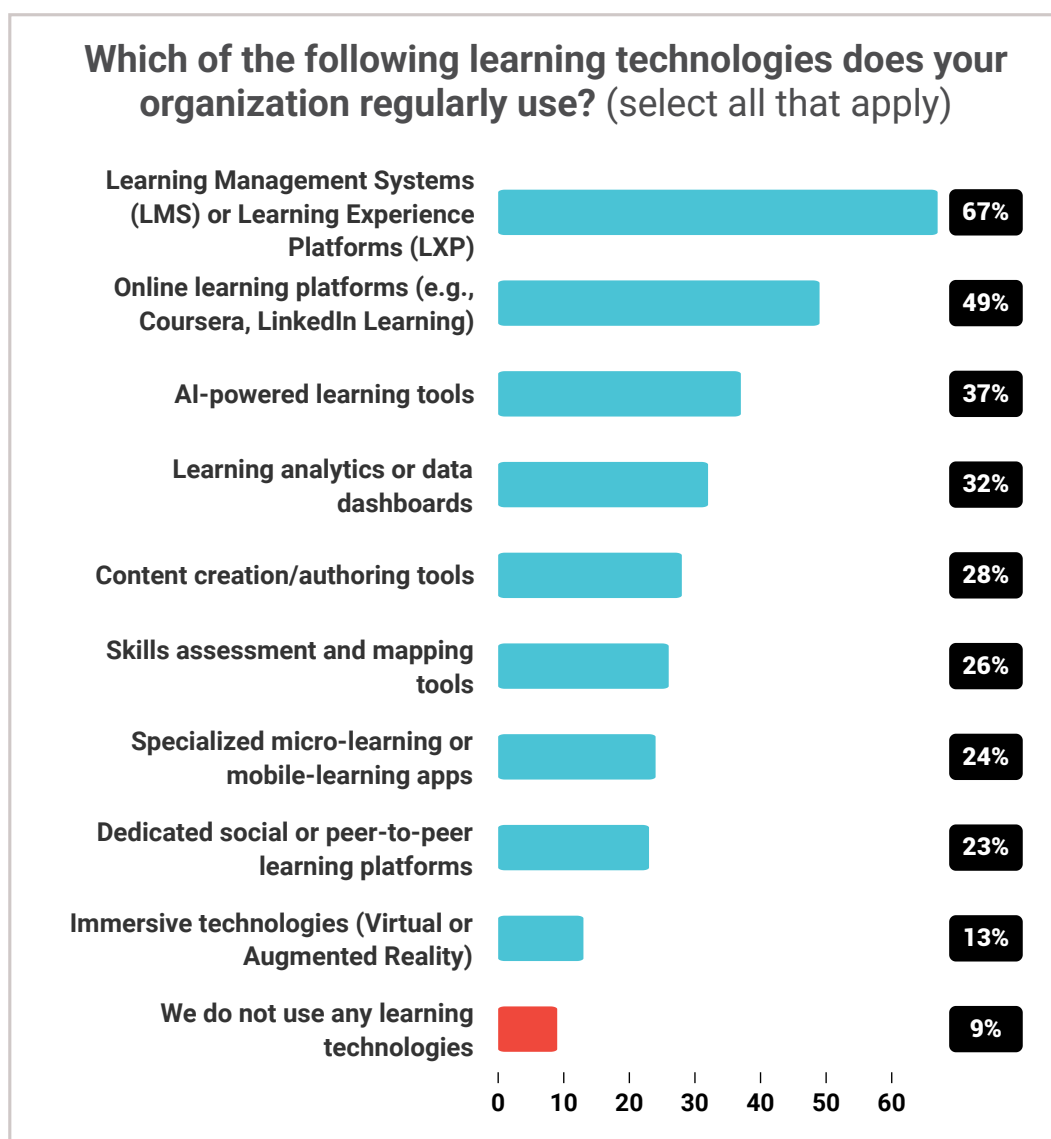
Which of the following learning technologies does your organization currently use? (select all that apply)



Note on Methodology: In 2023 and 2024, Learning Management Systems (LMS) and Learning Experience Platforms (LXP) were tracked as separate answer selections. The 2025 report combined these choices into a single line item ("LMS and/or LXP platforms"). The 2026 survey tool modified this combined phrasing slightly to "Learning Management Systems (LMS) or Learning Experience Platforms (LXP)". AI utility was not formally measured in the 2023 dataset.

The most notable change in the technology landscape is the rapid growth of AI-powered learning tools. Adoption increased from 14% in 2024 and 15% in 2025 to 37% in 2026, making AI one of the fastest-growing categories in the learning technology stack. Although AI can accelerate content creation and summarization, excessive reliance on these capabilities risks promoting [standardized](#) thinking rather than reinforcing organizational strengths.

As workforce development becomes increasingly dynamic, organizations may need to evaluate whether their technology investments align with how employees actually learn and develop skills.

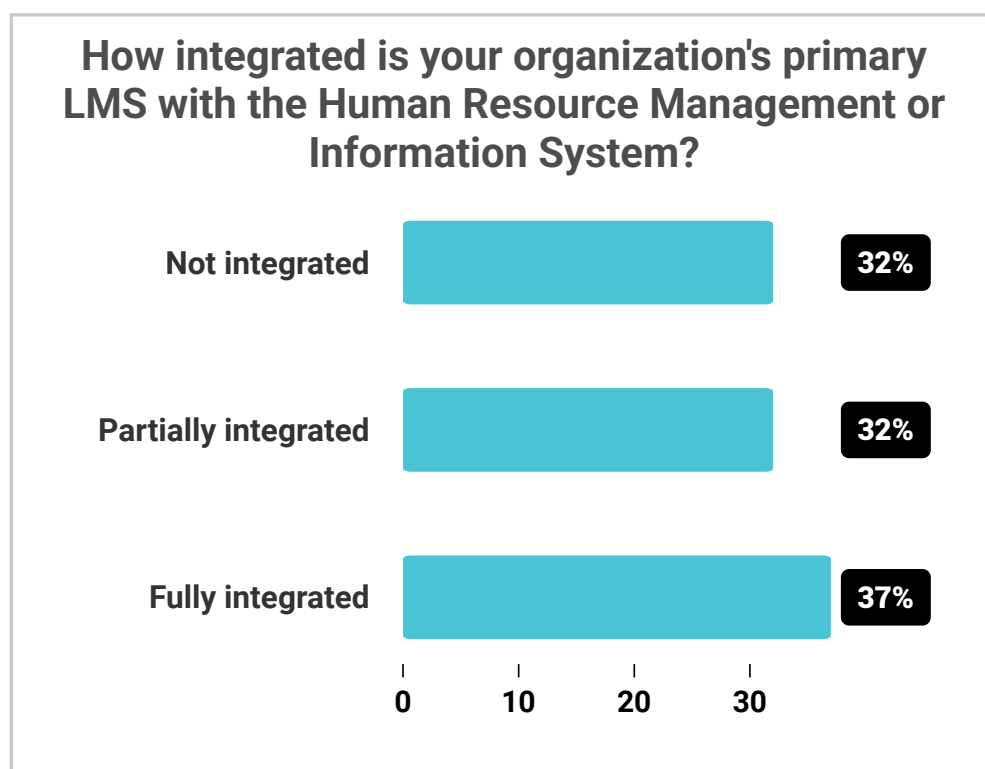




Finding: Only 37% of organizations report that their primary LMS is fully integrated with their core HR system

Organizations that use LMS reveal a fragmented approach to learning system integration. Organizations are divided almost evenly between those with fully integrated systems (37%), partially integrated systems (32%), and systems that are not integrated at all (32%).

Without integration, organizations often struggle to connect learning with performance, retention, internal mobility, and workforce planning outcomes. When learning and talent data reside in separate systems, visibility and decision-making suffer. As expectations for learning ROI increase, integration between learning and talent systems will become increasingly [important](#) for demonstrating business value.



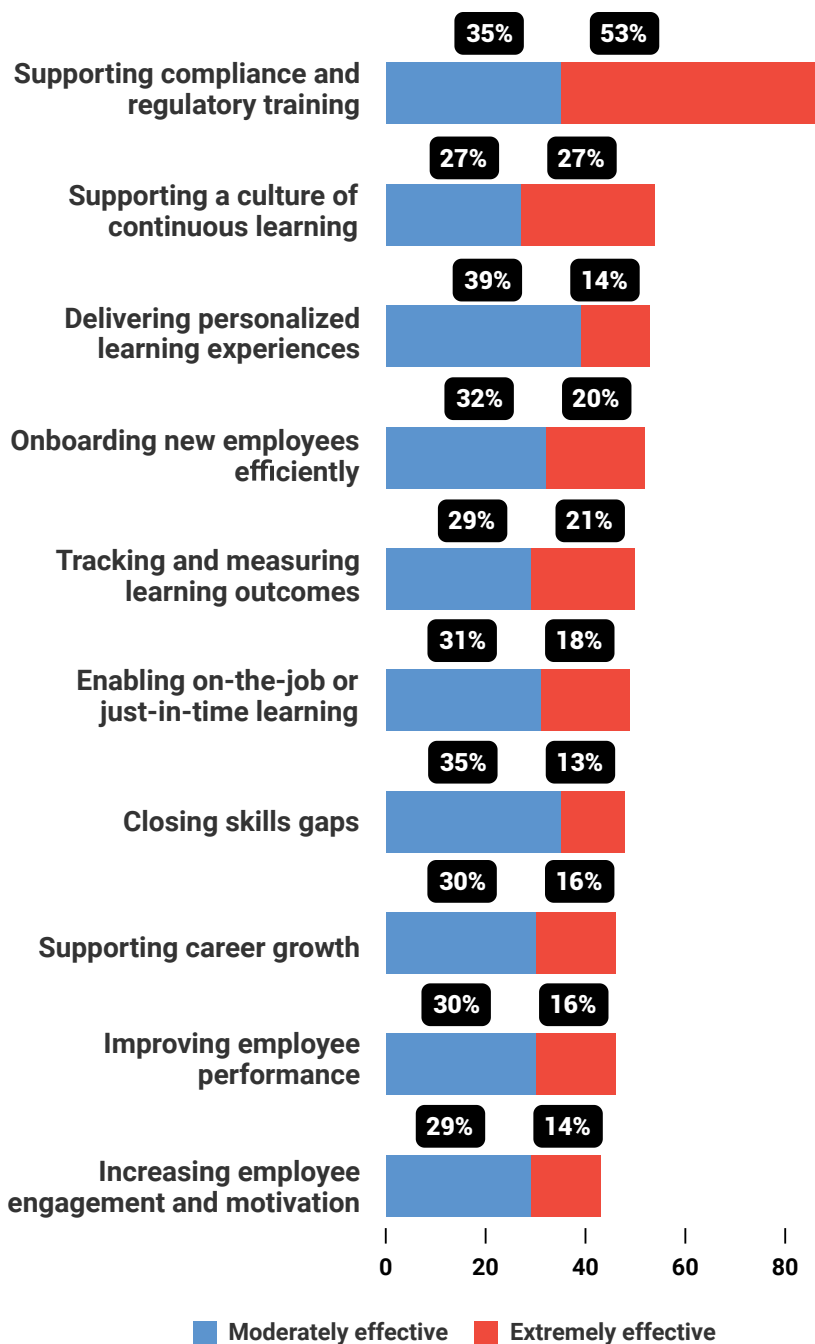


Finding: Almost nine in ten respondents rate their learning technologies as moderately or extremely effective for compliance and regulatory training

There is a gap between the administrative and developmental capabilities of learning technologies. Compliance and regulatory training remain the area where learning technologies perform best, with 88% of respondents rating their systems as moderately or extremely effective.

However, effectiveness declines sharply when organizations evaluate outcomes that are more closely tied to workforce capability. Only 13% rate their learning technologies as extremely effective at closing skill gaps, while 14% say the same for personalizing learning experiences.

Overall, how effective are your learning technologies at the following?



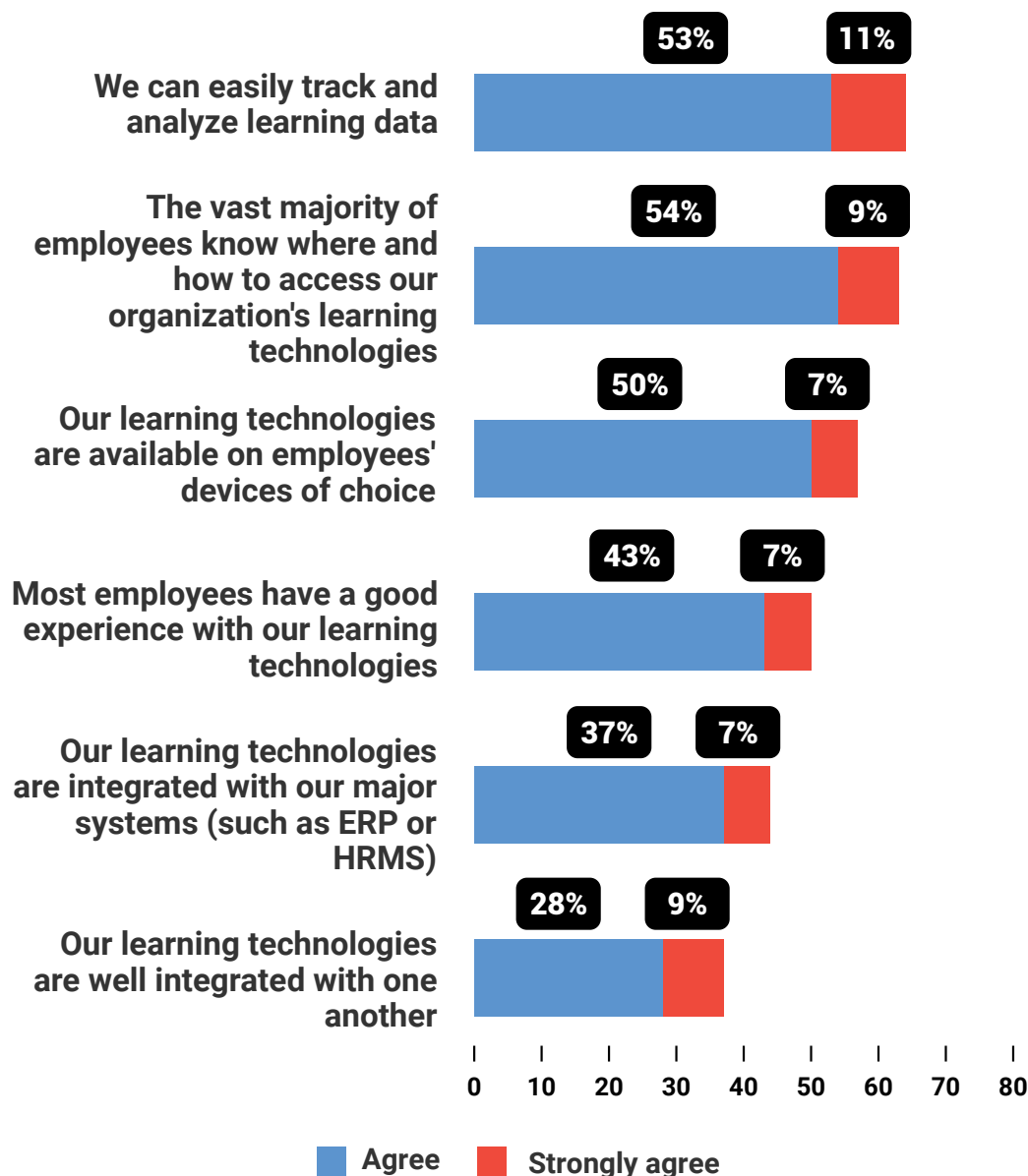


Finding: Sixty-three percent of respondents agree that most employees know how to find and access learning technologies

Employee access to learning technologies appears to be a relative strength for many organizations. Over six in ten (63%) respondents agree or strongly agree that employees know how to find and access learning technologies and 57% say their learning technologies work well across employees' preferred devices. This suggests that awareness and basic accessibility are not the primary barriers to learning technology adoption. Organizations also have improved capabilities in tracking learning data (64%).

However, the data reveals a gap between accessibility and integration. Many organizations continue to struggle with connecting learning technologies to one another and to broader "enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems." Under two-fifths (37%) of respondents agree or strongly agree that their learning technologies integrate effectively with one another, while under half (44%) agree or strongly agree that learning systems are well integrated with HR, ERP, and other business platforms. This disconnect may help explain why organizations continue to face challenges translating learning activity into workforce insights and business outcomes.

To what extent do you agree with the following statements about learning technologies in your organization?



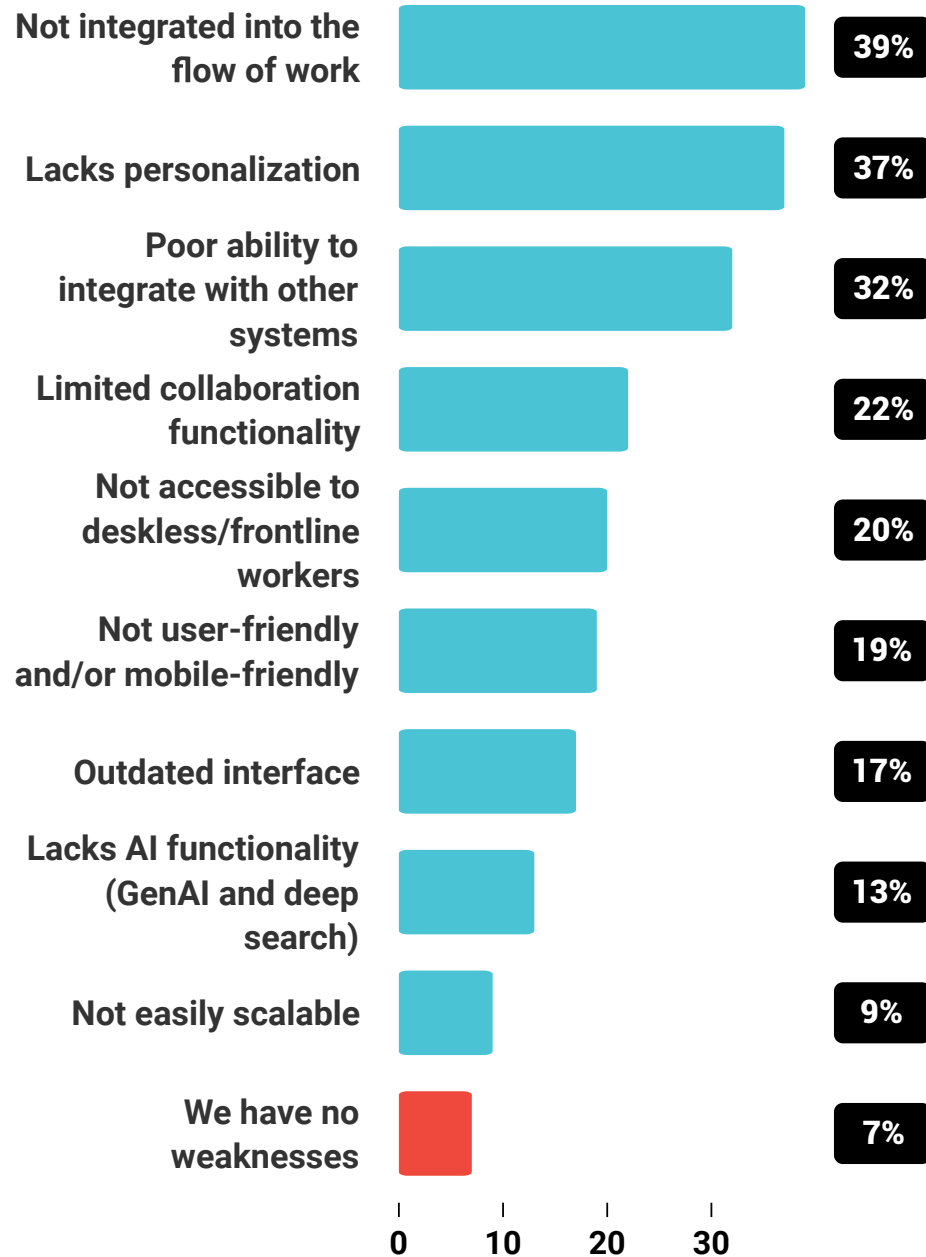


Finding: Two-fifths identify lack of integration into the flow of work as a weakness of learning technologies

Lack of integration into the flow of work is the most frequently cited weakness of learning technologies (39%). In addition, 37% identify lack of personalization and 32% say poor integration with other systems are challenges. Together, these findings indicate that organizations are concerned less with access to learning and more with how seamlessly learning fits into employees' day-to-day work experiences.

Research by the [Harvard Business Review](#) and the [American Psychological Association](#) suggests that frequent switching between applications creates a significant "toggle tax" that reduces productivity and fragments attention, making seamless learning integration increasingly important.

What are the 3 biggest technological weaknesses of your learning technology system? (select up to three)



Longitudinal data highlights how organizational priorities have evolved. Lack of personalization was the leading concern in 2023 at 50% but declined to 22% in 2025 before reaching 37% in 2026. While personalization remains important, workflow integration has emerged as a leading challenge, suggesting that organizations are increasingly focused on making learning easier to access, apply, and sustain within the context of work.



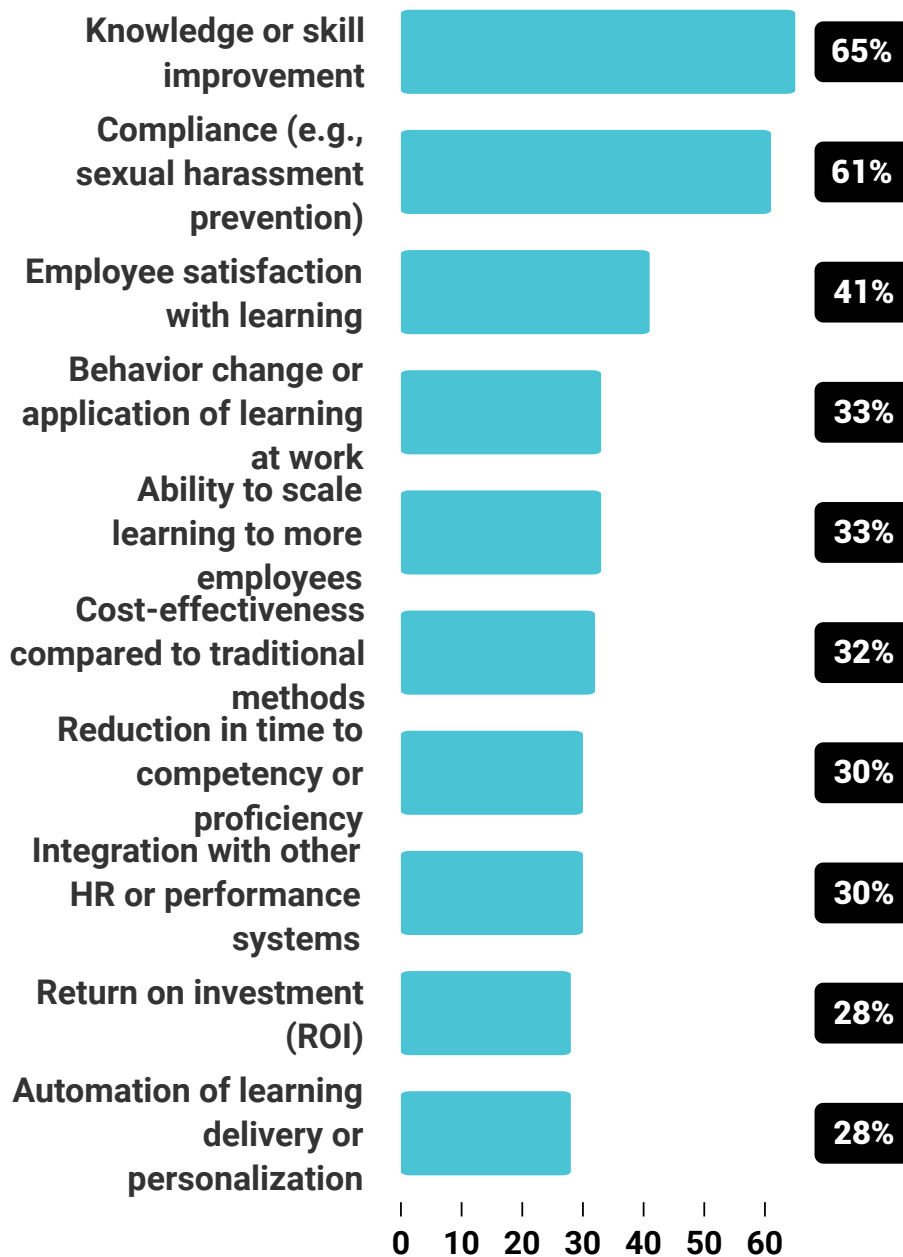
Finding: Nearly two-thirds of organizations evaluate L&D value primarily through immediate knowledge or skill improvement

Organizations continue to rely heavily on short-term indicators when measuring the success of learning initiatives. The most common measures of L&D value are knowledge or skill acquisition (65%), compliance outcomes (61%), and learner satisfaction (41%). While these metrics provide useful insight into whether employees completed training and gained new knowledge, they do not necessarily indicate whether learning translated into improved performance or organizational results.

Measures tied more directly to business outcomes remain less common. Only a third assess behavioral change on the job, scalability and cost-effectiveness. Most notably, just 28% calculate return on investment (ROI), suggesting that relatively few organizations formally quantify the business value generated by learning initiatives.

This measurement imbalance makes it harder for L&D teams to demonstrate strategic value. As executives increasingly [prioritize](#) productivity improvements and ROI, organizations may face growing pressure to adopt more outcome-focused measurement approaches.

How does your organization assess the impact of employee learning technologies in terms of organizational value? (select all that apply)



Experts agree that successful organizations distinguish themselves by shifting their focus away from surface-level engagement metrics toward tangible employee outcomes and integrated ecosystems. David Creelman advises organizations to *“rationally assess the impact of the technology without falling for tools that ‘sound good’ or get good scores on unreliable metrics (e.g., smile sheets).”*

Matthew Casey-Sudvary notes that the ultimate differentiator for a successful learning stack is simply whether it yields *“successful outcomes for employees.”* JD Dillon explains that market leaders do not view learning tech through functional silos.

“The organizations that foster continuous readiness and adaptation expand their perspective on ‘learning technology.’ They do not rely on isolated systems owned by specific functions. Instead, they adopt an ecosystem approach that activates the full range of tools, tactics, and technologies that enable people to improve their performance and drive outcomes—regardless of pre-defined categories or functional owners.” – JD Dillon

Expanding on this ecosystem perspective, Becky Willis underscores that realizing true value from technology depends heavily on organizational culture and leadership alignment. She notes that top-performing organizations are distinguished by a culture of support for TD (Talent Development), high employee engagement and retention, leadership support and value, alongside TD leaders able to increase learning maturity.

HRRI Strategic Recommendations

Based on our research, please consider the following suggestions:

1. Focus technology investments on integration, not expansion

Many organizations already have a broad mix of learning technologies in place. Before adding new platforms, evaluate whether existing systems work together effectively and support a seamless learner experience. Consider:

- reviewing connections between learning, HR, and talent systems
- reducing duplicate tools and overlapping functionality
- improving data sharing across platforms
- prioritizing technologies that support a unified employee experience

2. Connect learning data to talent and business outcomes

Learning data becomes more valuable when it is linked to workforce and business metrics.

Organizations should move beyond tracking course completions and begin connecting learning activity to broader talent outcomes. Consider:

- linking learning data to performance and career progression
- tracking the impact of development efforts on critical skill gaps
- integrating learning data into workforce planning discussions
- using skills data to support talent decisions

3. Use technology to support capability development, not just compliance

Learning technologies are often highly effective at delivering mandatory training but less effective at developing critical workforce capabilities. Organizations should evaluate whether their technology investments are helping employees build the skills needed for future success. Consider:

- strengthening skills-based learning pathways
- using technology to support personalized development
- identifying technologies that help employees apply learning on the job
- aligning learning tools with workforce capability priorities

4. Measure the impact of learning, not just participation

As expectations for workforce development increase, organizations need stronger evidence that learning investments are delivering value. Measurement approaches should focus on outcomes as well as activity. Consider:

- evaluating behavioral change and skill development
- tracking workforce readiness for critical roles
- measuring internal mobility and promotion outcomes
- assessing the business impact of learning initiatives